Charles E. Sumner High School
4248 W. Cottage Avenue
St. Louis, Missouri 63113

March 5, 2012

To Whom It May Concern:

It is with great honor and pleasure, I write to recommend Ms. Keena Moore, to the school leadership position. Ms. Moore has served as my 9th Grade Academy Coordinator, mentor, and supervisor during the 2011-2012 school year at Charles E. Sumner High School. During this time period, I was able to build a strong relationship with her as my administrator and feel confident that I am able to speak about her ability to continue to serve as a school leader. From the moment she was appointed to this role in the summer, she stepped up to the plate without a moment to waste and assisted with leading the entire school community in new positive "turnaround" direction.

Ms. Moore used her drive, determination, and desire to see student achievement in each of her decisions she made. This mindset helped create a school culture of success rather than failure amongst the freshmen. As a teacher and department chair at Sumner, I felt that she prepared the ninth grade team and students towards a pathway of academic success from the start of the year. She was supportive, provided meaningful feedback, assisted with data driven decision-making, maintained a culture of high expectations, and never settled for anything but the best for our students. Not only did she seek feedback constantly from us, but also she leads by example and maintains a constant line of open communication and high levels of integrity, accountability, and respect.

Although, Keena was not "officially" appointed to this role until the middle of August, she volunteered her time and expertise to the Planning Academy for core teachers. This was a vital time to prepare for the upcoming year and was a new initiative to drive teacher development and increase student outcomes. Ms. Moore was a major piece to this puzzle and did not hesitate when asked to volunteer her time. It is with this that I say she is committed and dedicated to student achievement. She focuses on academics as well as ensuring a strong school culture is cultivated, parental and community involvement, and strong attendance. Without Ms. Moore many of our activities and resources would not have been possible. It is because of her willingness to reach out to the community that our students had experiences that otherwise would not have been possible.

With the help and support of Keena, the staff was able to implement several new programs and extra curricular activities that were not allowed previously. The school community now offered Saturday School, after-school tutoring, and a credit recovery program to allow the students additional classroom time, added new classes that helped students on standardized tests, provided new after school programs that kept the students off of the streets and engaged in learning.

Considering this was my first year as a department chair and third year as a classroom teacher, I could not have asked for a more ideal administrator and leader. With the help and leadership form Ms. Keena Moore, Sumner High School is able to have the highest average daily attendance it has had in the last several years, students failure rates have been decreased, standardized tests results are projected to be higher than previous years, students were more engaged in learning and activities, parents and community were involved at a new high, and student's were in the classroom more instead of being suspended.

It is without any hesitation, that I strongly recommend, Ms. Keena Moore, for the role of school leader. I would be more than happy to discuss Ms. Moore in further details, at any time. I can be reached via email at Kevin.Martin@slps.org or by cell phone at (630) 709-4652.

Respectfully,

Kevin M. Martin
Mathematics Department Chair
Charles E. Sumner High School